

# Shimin Hu

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## PROFILE

PhD researcher and prior AI/NLP product manager with experience in statistical modeling, experimental research, and generative AI product development. Skilled at translating ambiguous user and business problems into testable hypotheses, clear product requirements, quantitative analyses, and measurable outcomes.

## EDUCATION

**University of Massachusetts Amherst** — PhD in Cognition & Cognitive Neuroscience | GPA: 3.9 September 2024 - Present  
**London School of Economics (LSE)** — MSc in Behavioural Science January 2022  
**University of Nottingham Ningbo China** — BSc in International Business Economics July 2020

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Programming and analysis:** R, MATLAB, Python, SQL; **Methods:** A/B testing, linear models, multivariate analysis, computational modeling, psychometric analysis, experimental design; **Research tools:** EEG, PsychoPy, Pavlovia, Qualtrics

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Trip.com Group** April 2024 - August 2024

*User Experience Research intern*

- Conducted mixed-methods user research, including competitive analysis and interviews with 30 users, combining qualitative insights with quantitative behavioral data to identify usability gaps, user needs, localization issues, and product opportunities.
- Used eye-tracking and behavioral data to evaluate users' visual attention, information-search patterns, and navigation behavior, translating findings into actionable UX recommendations.
- Created and evaluated user flows, wireframes, and interactive prototypes in Figma, collaborating with product and design teams to improve interface clarity and usability.

**Alibaba Group – AliExpress**

April 2022 - July 2023

*Product Manager, AI & NLP*

- Developed generative AI tools for product descriptions, images, and multilingual content with algorithm teams; translated merchant needs into product requirements, increasing feature usage by 10% and reducing content production time by 30%.
- Designed and iterated prompts and system instructions for AI-generated content; evaluated model outputs and recurring failure patterns to support prompt refinement and model validation.
- Evaluated product changes through A/B testing and analysis of CTR, CVR, GMV, engagement, and conversion funnels; developed SEO strategies that increased organic search CTR by 5%.
- Supported personalized ranking and knowledge graph initiatives by defining product tags, category taxonomies, user profile attributes, and relevance criteria; ranking improvements were associated with a 7% increase in CVR.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Color Coherence and Numerosity Visual Perception** | Lead Research Project August 2024 - Present

- Designed and programmed complementary EEG and online behavioral experiments to investigate how visual features influence quantity judgments, with applications to visual information design, user attention, and data-display usability.
- Built and managed a 2×2 within-subject study with 400 trials per participant, including randomized and counterbalanced conditions, automated trial-level validation, and online participant recruitment and data collection.
- Translated complex behavioral and neural results into testable design insights about when visual features help, distract, or systematically bias human decisions

**Human-AI Interaction and Decision-Making** | Study Design

August 2025 - Present

- Designed experiments testing how the number of AI agents, confidence levels, and explanations affect user trust and decision accuracy.
- Defined measurable outcomes to inform the design of clearer, more trustworthy, and user-centered AI systems.
- Developing a local LLM evaluation pipeline using Hugging Face to compare single- and multi-model decision support.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Instructor, PSYCH 337: Writing in Psychological & Brain Sciences (Spring 2026, Fall 2026)
- Teaching Assistant, PSYCH 310: Sensation and Perception (Fall 2025)

## HONORS AND LEADERSHIP

UMass Leadership Program; LSE Scholarship; Second Place, Unilever Global Business Case Competition; Head's Scholarship